The Churchill CHRONICLE

Issue 05 April 2021

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IDENTITY PLACEHOLDERS

By: Grace Du

I see personalities as extended projects. We cultivate them, salvage the decent parts, and then we put them on display. This process is brutal for me because I'm indecisive, reserved, and bad at being a person overall. I wish it was as easy as getting some instant personality packets and dissolving them in hot water. That never happened, so instead, the Internet answered my pleas for individuality. I present to you the results of my self-discovery.

Western Astrology - I've always questioned the legitimacy of the zodiac. Pseudosciences should know their place, but astrology has all the misplaced confidence of a middle schooler. It gauges personality, compatibility with others, and prospects for the future based on the stars' alignment at an individual's birth. The needless complexity isn't even the worst aspect of astrology. The disparities within the zodiac symbols are easily more insulting. Capricorn is a suave goat-fish, and I, a Libra, am a scale. Not even a fish scale, a lame scale that measures mass. I think it's delusional to regard the zodiac as some universal truth, but the signs are harmless and thought-provoking. When I read the words "avoids confrontation" and "self-pity" under Libra traits, the illusion of being understood almost transformed into a palpable feeling.

16 Personalities - The Myers-Briggs Type Indicator is a questionnaire that predicts how people perceive their environment and make decisions. The test examines four dimensions of personality: introversion/extroversion, sensing/intuition, thinking/feeling, and judging/perceiving. An endearing, geometric character represents each of the sixteen different personality types, complete with a report on strengths and weaknesses, romantic relationships, friendships, parenthood, career paths, and workplace habits. I believe my MBTI results are an accurate reflection of me, and retaking the test does not alter my type. Still, quantifying personality is a slippery slope. Who's to say your mood won't influence the bubbles you press, or that there are sixteen types and not seven billion?

Aesthetics - Now we're entering subculture territory, where the variety and potential for escapism will engulf you. Many aesthetics take an ideal, typically a society without capitalism, and romanticize it. Attire, scenery, and behaviour can all convey an aesthetic. Cottagecore features white, flowy garments, gardens, and baking. It emphasizes subsistence and harmony with nature. For a solid grasp of Dark Academia, picture a scholar writing poetry and brooding in a castle. Other prominent aesthetics include grunge, skater, minimalist, and vaporwave. Much to my chagrin, I can't identify with an aesthetic, as they're all eerily perfect. I can admire the beauty from afar, but getting too close would wound me.

Astrology, 16 Personalities, and aesthetics are all deceptively convenient solutions to my identity crisis. For now, it's just me and my fluctuating moral compass against the world.

INTOXICATION

Even from far away,
You could see it.
They were drunk.
But not from any type of beverage, no.
They were drunk off each other.
The way laughs enveloped them.
The way glances distracted them.
And though each of them knew the other
Was looking too,
Open-ended euphoria captivated them.
The way they curled into each other
With nervousness hidden behind
A subtle excitement.
Even from far away,
You could see it
They found each other,
Utterly intoxicating.

- Fiza Rafeeq

Photo by: Elena Meng

I Will Always Live In This Castle

Lakhshan Amin

This castle is three hundred years old. It has never been altered, repaired, or changed. I have been living here since the day I was born and I will stay in this castle forever. The house has an odd history; my parents died in this castle, their parents died in this castle, and I will die in this castle. I picture what it was like, walking down these halls back when they were first built. No echoes, no voices, and absolutely no fear. I wake up every morning, astonished, I made it through the night; the shadows follow me everywhere I look. The portraits hanging on the walls come to life behind my back and whisper about me. They gossip. The loudest one is the large gold-framed man at the end of the corridor on the first floor. He's the boss. I hear him complain about my shoes and the way they scratch the hardwood. I hear the others agree unanimously. No one has ever spoken without being told by him that they are able to. He died in this castle three hundred years ago and I will die here three hundred years later. My parents always told me to embrace death. They said fearing it would cause unnecessary pain, yet, in their last moments, they begged me to help them. My mother's eyes were bright green and full of happiness, it made me sick. She didn't understand this castle, she wanted to leave. I will always live in this castle. My father was a kind man and for some inexplicable reason, he cared about the sufferings of those around us. It made me sick. My mother was the man of the house; anything she said was the law. But she never heard the voices of the paintings, never saw the shadows, never feared falling asleep forever. I never understood it.

Last Tuesday, she walked to the end of the corridor on the first floor, where I was talking to my friends and told me we were leaving the castle. Impossible. We will always live in this castle. That's when the painting told me how to fix it. How to make sure I never leave. The house had been infested with rats for the last four or so years, so we happened to have copious amounts of rat poison laying around. It was so simple. Last Friday we sat down for the last dinner in this castle. I watched them scarf down their steaks, begging me to at least take a bite of mine. They made me sick. Once they realized it was too late, they were foaming at the mouths, coughing blood, begging me to help them. The last words of my insolent mother and father were so inconsequential, I didn't even bother remembering them. The man at the end of the corridor told me I'm not going to wake up tomorrow. My friends always look out for me; I will always live in this castle.

The Power of Lasting Habits

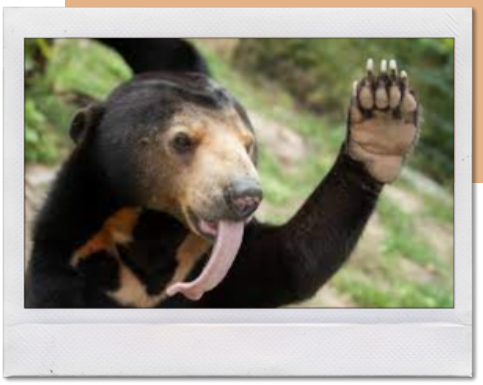
Hana Aref Taher

There is a fundamental difference between stagnancy and having a routine. Many falsely believe that having a routine leads to a monotonous life that lacks adventure and spontaneity. The reality is vastly different. Having a productive and effective routine provides us with more free time which gives us the opportunity to have fun and do the things we enjoy. The benefits of lasting habits are endless, they can be a tool that allows us to both maximize productivity and prioritize our health. Ultimately, habits allow us to make huge improvements through small changes. Let's say you have a goal to improve your grades by a couple of percentages; let's analyze how infinitesimal habits can lead to that. By going to bed 30 minutes earlier, exercising through a 20-minute walk, and ensuring that you are eating an appropriate serving of greens, you will be able to increase your focus and attention in class and during exams. These small changes are incredibly easy to incorporate into your day, but their impacts will have a ripple effect into something huge. However, as many of us have experienced, forming lasting habits is more difficult than it may appear. I conducted some research in order to determine the most effective methods of creating long-term habits.

The first step to building a good habit is to identify the habits that we unknowingly already have. For instance, you could start by writing down steps you go through during weekdays after school. By writing it down you will be able to identify the flaws and perhaps the changes you want to make. The next step would be to incorporate new habits into your existing ones. If your goal is to exercise more, what would you do to encourage this habit? Many make the mistake of setting goals such as "I will work out after school" or "I will work out before I eat dinner". The problem with these phrases is that they are too vague to be effective in the long-term. Will you work out after school as soon as you get home, or after you spend some time relaxing, or after you have finished all of your schoolwork? This goal is not specific enough to push you to form a habit that comes naturally. A better goal would be "I will change into workout clothes as soon as I get home and have had a small snack." This is specific enough to ensure that you know exactly what you are doing and when you are doing it. The next step is to ask yourself what you can do to make this habit come more naturally. This may mean creating a playlist of workout videos that you can easily access to save time, or it may mean setting your workout clothes aside in the morning so that they are in front of you when you get home. The alternative to working out would be to spend hours on your phone scrolling through social media. Your phone and snacks are right there in front of you, therefore, why would you want to choose a more difficult task? It should ultimately be your goal to make your habits come naturally, and the best way to do that is to make them easily accessible and attainable.

RILEY'S BEAR REVIEWS

SUN BEAR



BEAR HAIKU

Really big ol' tongues
Human in a fake bear suit
They eat Helium?

The Sun Bear or helarctos malayanus lives throughout Southeast Asia, primarily in Cambodia, Myanmar, Malaysia, and on the sun's surface. Although part of the bear family, the Sun Bear is fairly distinct from other bears; one could even say the Sun Bear and the Polar Bear are... polar opposites. The Sun Bear's most noticeable feature is its extreme heat resistance. This stems from their habitat around the South China Sea and the surface of the sun, where temperatures can reach up to 40 and 6000 degrees Celsius respectively. Bearologists are still unsure as to how the Sun Bear was first able to reach the surface of a star. The leading theory is that long before humans, Sun Bears achieved civilization and subsequently space travel before a catastrophic disaster. This disaster was possibly caused by gene editing, leading to a slave revolt. As a result, refugees fled to the sun as a final refuge away from the civil war tearing their society apart. However, scientists are still unsure. The Sun Bear's diet is mostly composed of pure elemental Helium, which they then smash together through sheer force of will in a fusion reaction in their stomach. Although the use of nuclear energy has given Sun Bears much more energy compared to other bears which contribute to them not having to hibernate, this characteristic also resulted in a food crisis for earthbound Sun Bears which now have to face a lack of Helium.

In case you can't tell already, this bear is a Claw on the Riley's Bear Reviews scale of Claw or Nah. You may ask, "why isn't it a Nah given the subpar abilities of the Sun Bear in their natural habitat?" I for one welcome our new masters from the sun and hope you have a fun time in heretic jail. Any animal able to live, even thrive on the surface of a star is well beyond our comprehension, and the fact that it's also a bear? That is a godly combination if I've ever seen one. As with any revanchist state, these Sun Bears are obviously going to return to their birthright with a vengeance, at which point I suggest going back in time and starting a monthly bear review column to avoid their wrath. So from all of us here at Riley's Bear Reviews: praise Sol Invicta, bless the bears, remember to hide food high in the air, and good luck.

-Riley M, Ph.D. Bearology, Grand Pope of Sol Ursus

BY EMILY WANG

WATER PHOENIX

A girl emerges from the surface of a tranquil teal ocean, seemingly confident. In the deep ocean just a few minutes earlier, the peculiar textbook-like animals had seen the girl swim slowly in directions of confusion. In the sea of her mind, she was dragged down by the forceful seaweed beneath, almost drowning. Spiraling into fantasia or nightmares, miles away from cognizance. While her mind was lost, two seahorses appeared nearby. The male and female seahorse came together to dance, their outer appearances transformed into a colossal of colours with their tails entwined.The two seahorses seemed to be having a courtship dance, but it soon ended after a few seconds. Maybe they realized it was not going to work out, incompatibility was the issue. The only thing reminiscent was their goodbye dance, moving on to another path. Afterwards, the girl witnessed two baby green turtles playing a game of tag, chuckling at the sight of them trying to run after one another and hiding in the coral reefs. They looked so carefree, just concerned about their little game. She looked up and noticed a resplendent golden light glowing, delicately then boisterously. A sign of fascination, she took a deep breath as she swam up. Noticing the starry night, she sat on the warm sand, in awe of the stars. Some stars shone more brightly, some appeared to emit vibrant hues. All unaware of how special they each were.

Is Modern Art 'Real Art'? - Wannabe Philosophy

By Lysiane Kouakou

Modern art isn't a stranger to criticism. For many, the term 'modern art' brings up the idea of ridiculously simple pieces sold at outrageous prices.

For example:

The painting "Untitled (1961)" by Mark Rothko, was sold at $28 million and consists entirely of two rectangles of orange paint. "The blood-red mirror" by Gerhard Richter, a canvas painted entirely in a single shade of red, was sold for $1.1 million. $43.8 million "Onement Vi" by Barnett Newman consists of two dark blue rectangles of paint, separated by a thin line of light blue paint down its middle. The pieces' blatant simplicity, paired with their hefty price-tags, has brought the validity of this art form into question.

By definition, art is the expression or application of human creativity and imagination (typically in a visual form such as a painting or a sculpture) to produce works appreciated primarily for their beauty or emotional power. Using that definition alone, modern art should have no issue being accepted as a valid art form. However, this is not the case. One of the most common arguments used against the validity of this art form is the supposed lack of skill or talent required for it. In short, some of these pieces look as if they could be made by a regular-joe or even a child. When people think of art, they think of ingenuity, beauty, and skill; something is never seen before, or at least difficult to replicate.

In my opinion, art doesn't have to include uniqueness, beauty, or skill. Anything made with the intent to express oneself creatively can be classified as art if the creator deems it so. To me, classifying which pieces of art count as 'real art' or not is counterproductive. Art is known to be liberating, so why attempt to box it into 'correct' and 'incorrect' boxes?

This being said, I still don't think $1.1 million for a red canvas is money well-spent. I believe that it is art, but I don't necessarily like it or see it as good. It's an important distinction - one that more people should consider. Is it fair to deem something invalid just because you don't like it? Or even because most people don't like it?

Not everything is made to be examined through an objective lens. In my opinion, modern art (money-laundering claims aside) is valid, and there's no such thing as 'real' or 'fake' art.

The Current State of Anti-Asian Racism in Canada

David Wu

Amidst the ongoing pandemic, the amount of hate crimes against Asians in Canada has risen up to over 600%. Recent events, especially the shooting that took place in Atlanta, Georgia, have compelled the province of Ottawa to call for an end to racism against Asians across Canada. The shooting spree ended up with 8 dead, 6 of them being Asian women. The attacker of the incident, Robert Aaron Long, claimed to be suffering from sexual addictions that influenced him to target these adult women in a location that he believed was a place of temptation.

The police declared this case as not racially charged, with Captain Jay Baker of the county sheriff's office remarking that "[that day] was a really bad day for him and this is what he did". Many communities across Canada say otherwise, especially Ottawa resident Melissa Mui. Melissa was shocked to see the incident on social media and believes this may only be the tip of the iceberg for racial attacks. With this kind of fear, many Asians in Canada and America are scared to be living in what they previously believed were fairly accommodating countries. The segregation between Asians and those with anti-Asian prejudice has left communities in turmoil. Amy Go, the President of the Chinese National Council for Social Justice (CCNC-SJ), believes that there is a need for strong political leaders, action from the police, and systemic changes to fix the perpetual racism.

Justified Anger

By: Ankita Chaturvedi

What causes a person to become angry?

We can think of anger as a subject evaluated on a spectrum as it varies from person to person. I want to explore the topic of anger and specifically how one can deal with it.

Say something does not turn out the way you had initially planned. What do you do? You could become angry, but how long will you remain angry? What are the internal and external consequences of this emotion? What do you see as the "end goal" of this choice? While the feeling of anger is valid and reasonable, it is not necessarily the most logical approach in low-scale situations, especially not under circumstances where you are unable to "quit." Furthermore, our anger is not reserved exclusively to ourselves; upon feeling angry, many of our interactions with others foster a negative mood, due to our own powerful emotions projecting onto others. These external harms can vary from simply speaking in a rude tone to directing your anger towards an innocent person in hopes to alleviate your frustration. For example, while scoring a low grade on a test that you studied hard for may ignite a sense of anger, it is also crucial to realize the ultimate outcome of choosing to feel angry. That is, the fact that you will likely take more tests in the future and possibly experience this scenario again. In this case, the most logical approach would be to receive the grade, analyze where you went wrong and then fine-tune your studying method to account for these sources of error. Honestly speaking, the logical approach is not very realistic. I feel that we should focus on striking a balance between the two ends of the spectrum: sheer anger and complete logic.

What does this balance look like? Before we can understand this concept of balancing our emotions for long-term benefits to our self-esteem and motivation, we need to further look into the idea of optimism and its pros and cons. To be purely optimistic in the face of all adversity can be an ineffective strategy, though the same can be said for pessimism. In the situations I outlined above — those being scenarios in which you are likely to continue the activity from which your anger initiated — a certain level of optimism allows for individual growth. Jumping back to the example of a low score on a test, you must believe in the fact that you can and will achieve a higher score on the next test, while also putting in the time and effort to do so. In short, to mitigate the harms of anger (decreased motivation, soured mood and negative impact on others) when faced with a low-scale situation, consider the impact of your words and actions in regards to your self-esteem and future activities.

"Why are we Entertained by the Enjoyment of Others?"

By: Anonymous

Recently, I have begun watching live streams from some of my favourite YouTubers. When my mother discovered this, she brought up an interesting point: why was I watching people play games instead of playing something myself? This led me to think deeper about the appeal of live streams and podcasts where someone watches or listens to others rather than partaking in these activities themselves.

More recently, live streams for the once-popular game "Among Us" have been enjoyed by many. I believe that a fair amount of people watch these streams just as much, if not more than they play the game themselves. I have thought of a few reasons why this may be the case.

Firstly, many individuals who are invested in a game wish to see the gameplay of a more experienced player so they may learn strategies and become better themselves. They may also enjoy the satisfaction of a successful game if they do not win many rounds themselves. Even if they do, they likely don't have footage of their greatest plays.

Alternatively, in the case of multiplayer games such as "Among Us", you may not always have a group of friends ready to play when you desire. Furthermore, people on the internet who play competitively are often rude or uninterested in playing the way you wish to. Thus, individuals may prefer not to play online. However, watching a stream or video allows them to see gaming content without actually playing the game.

It's also possible that people playing the game are of more interest to an individual than the game that is being played. Personally, I enjoy the live streams I watch mainly for the humour and conversation that the participants bring. Other than the game's ability to create scenarios in which a joke can be made, I care little about its content.

As for podcasts, listening to other people talk can be a source of white noise for relaxation after a long day. While you may not be voicing your own opinions, hearing the thoughts of others can be quite intriguing. This is especially the case if you have an interest in the people speaking or the topic they are discussing.

On the surface, watching someone else do something sounds extremely boring. Yet, people all over the world consume this content on a regular basis. Thinking deeper, however, logical reasons for this interest can be found. There are likely more psychological explanations for this attraction beyond what I've listed, but the question proposed by my mother made me wonder why we genuinely enjoy what we watch.

Blank

by Melanie Chan

Every page
Every canvas
Every piece
Begins blank

These unpainted paintings
And unwritten stories
Are left to the ones
Who dare to dream

Pouring everything
Everything
All of who they are
Onto the silent snowy sheets

This sketchbook
All three hundred sixty five pages
Is left for you to fill

Realistic
Abstract
Muted
Vibrant
Pencil
Paint
Charcoal
Watercolour

Photograph
by Katrina Chu

The pages seem endless
More and more sketchbooks
More and more canvases
More and more pieces
All of your own

Your urge will be to make every single one perfect.

But in the end
All you will have left
Is what you created

Is it not more valuable to see progress than perfection?
In the end
I hope it is beautiful
And I hope none of them will be
Blank

ABYSS

By: Lavanya Menon

I spend my time
teetering on the edge of what could be
a thrilling life.
One leg over into an abyss
while the other desperately clings
To any semblance of safety
To any semblance of something known.

In my daily rhythms
I find myself
running along this edge
Hoping to accidentally miss a beat,
Falter,
or lose my footing.

Hoping to be thrown into the abyss
Of everything unfamiliar
Everything unknown and new.
The dark abyss that feels oddly alluring

Sometimes I find myself hoping that
Fate will take the wheel
And send me falling for so long
I finally realize I'm flying.

BREAKING POINT

AIDAH ARBAB

Note: This is a work of fiction based on real-life events.

They had been so close – or maybe they'd never been. Maybe it had just felt that way. It no longer feels that way now.

Myanmar had technically been free for decades, but the people had not. Not as much as they wanted to be. But then there had been whispers of civilian rule and democracy. He and his family had held their breath because it finally felt like something was changing for the better. But then the military staged a coup against Myanmar's true elected government – because of election fraud. They disregarded their promises, the constitution, and the peoples' will.

He knows what it is like to have your entire world turned upside down. He had hoped such a feeling would have been put behind them, that they would never have to face such a change ever again. He ignores Min Aung Hlaing's and the military's explanations. He knows better than to trust them now.

The change – the betrayal – is overwhelming and disheartening. The world watches, waiting to see the explosions and to see violence break out.

At first, it is quiet. There is anger after the coup, of course. So much anger, but very little violence. He sometimes sees those that support the military waving flags, but in terms of activity, there is not much else.

Later, there is enough protest to make up for the temporary standstill. One cannot attempt to undo a decade of progress without pushback. One cannot attempt to stop such a thing without pushback, either. Not in Myanmar. The protest is peaceful, but the response to it is not.

...

Millions of people from all demographics pour out onto the streets carrying signs, wearing helmets, and holding shields. Workers from a myriad of industries strike, hunted MPs unite, and the nation comes together to free its leaders. To hold their military accountable. To bring about democracy.

Over one hundred people die.

...

The police open fire on the innocent. The military arrests the civilian-backed government. The security forces kidnap thousands from their homes in the dark of night.

This is the price of earning freedom.

Some days, it feels like defeat. Still, children are dying. Still, people are starving. Still, the military rules with an iron fist.

He remembers what his parents and grandparents went through all those years ago and thinks about the gains he has seen in Myanmar in the past decade alone. He wants that for himself, for his children, and for his country. He wants it too much to let it go, so he and his fellow citizens find it within themselves to stay strong and to stand tall, day after day.

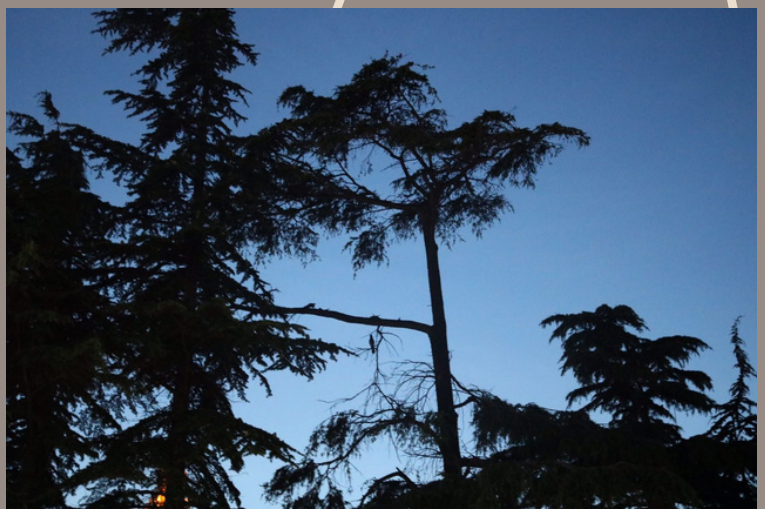
The overthrown but surviving civilian government – the one the people were owed – promise a revolution against their current terrorist military government. They promise dawn after such a dark time, and he believes that it is coming.

He just hopes he'll be alive when it does.

HAIKU

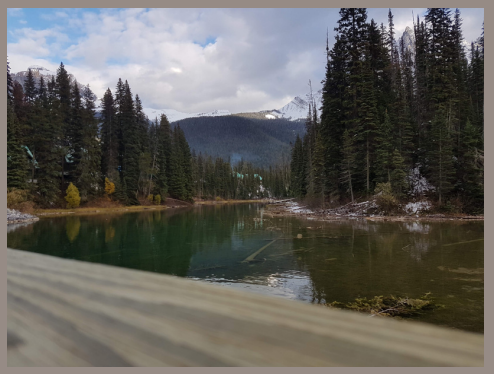
MISHEEL LKHAGVASUREN

A slow silent stream
Raindrops skip across the surface
Splat! A fish pops out



PHOTOGRAPH BY: AYLA BABER

HOBBIES THAT I PICKED UP, THAT YOU SHOULD TOO



PHOTOGRAPH BY: CAMI HSIEH

Honestly, if someone asked me what my hobbies were a while ago, I would've been at a loss. School, family, and other obligations take up my time, and the rest is spent on my phone. Even though phones are used for connecting - especially during Covid- the rest of the time is unproductive and wasted.

My goal was to develop more skills and hobbies during quarantine. In this column, I will share some hobbies that I picked up during these difficult (and boring) times, and some others that I have seen become more popular. My hope is that we can spend more time utilizing our creativity and less time on our phones.

I. Homemade Jewelry

Using homemade bakeable clay, you can make homemade jewelry. This method is getting a lot more popular, and it's easy to make as well.

There are just three ingredients; 2 parts flour to 1 part salt and 1 part water (Optional: You can add some oil).

After making and shaping your dough, bake at 350 degrees for around 20-30 minutes until hard, and then paint your jewelry however you'd like.

II. Gardening

If gardening seems challenging and tough right now, you're not alone. I have killed many plants out of neglect before I was able to even nurture any that lasted. The good thing about gardening is that there are a variety of different difficulty levels. You can also reuse your houseplants by propagating them- that is cutting up a plant a few centimeters below a leaf node and placing it in water. A more challenging, but fun idea, is to plant food and herbs such as basil, mint, and tomatoes. The best time to plant is right now during Spring, so make sure you are ready.

III. Baking

Baking has always been a popular hobby, and chances are, you have most of the ingredients you need at home. One recipe that I mastered over quarantine was chocolate chip cookies. The first time trying a new recipe may seem stressful and without any previous experience baking, chances are that you will mess up. My first batch of cookies was too dry and eating them could possibly chip your tooth. However, with practice and a modified recipe, making cookies is a lot easier now, and it will be for you too.

IV. Embroidery

If any of you know how to hand-stitch, embroidery will be a lot easier to get into. You can order supplies online, or go to any craft store. You'll need an embroidery hoop, floss, and needles. Though an embroidery hoop is used very often to stabilize your embroidery, if you don't have one, that is still perfectly fine. This is an incredibly simple way to customize your wardrobe and make whatever you'd like cute and unique.

By looking through this list, I hope that something here has inspired you to start a new hobby or to pick up an old one. I hope all of you are well and staying safe. See you next month.

NAIMA NOOR

PHOTOGRAPH BY: ETHAN KWAN

Loosening Up

Zoha Ahmad

An irony, however hard it tries,
Will always be crisp.
Never forget the firm and crunchy irony.

All that is soft is not cheer,
A cheer, by all accounts, is loud.
A cheer is deafening, a cheer is garish,
a cheer is loud-voiced, however.

Wittiness, however hard it tries,
Will always be yellow.
Never forget the jaundiced and dishonourable wittiness.

Pay attention to the witticism,
Witticism is the biggest message of all.
Down, down, down into the darkness of the witticism,
Gently it goes - the king-sized, the cock-a-hoop, the extensive.

Isabelle Imambaksh

Work in Progress

Photo by

Aaminah Ali

Classmate

Adora Chen

Hey!

You don't know me.

I'm the one sitting at the back in your social class, but...

Sometimes I lay awake at night.

I wonder why you're insecure about your crooked teeth,
Or your hair,
Or your weight,
Or your skin,
Or maybe your intelligence,
Your decisions,
Your emotions,
Your real you.

I mean seriously

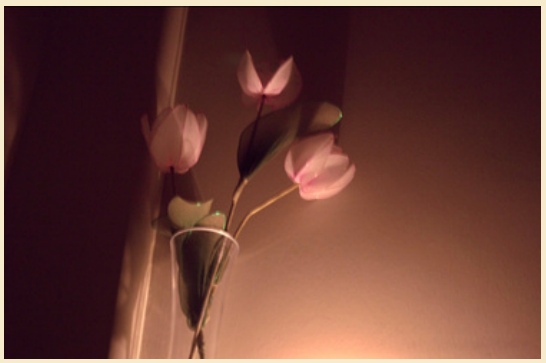
I don't know you either -

But you're already incredible, classmate

STUDENTS' GROWING CONCERNS ABOUT HALLWAY CONDITIONS By Arushi Varier

Many students at Sir Winston Churchill High School, who wish to remain anonymous, have expressed concern about the conditions of the school's hallways as case numbers continue to rise. Some students believe that the hallways are too congested, which becomes troubling in the middle of the pandemic. A student told the Churchill Chronicle that "it honestly depends on the hallway, but the [main floor's] hallway and the middle hallway upstairs get very crowded." When the student was asked about their opinion on the role of the arrows, designed to encourage students to walk facing one direction, they told the Chronicle that "[the arrows are not helping right now]...but people should be urged to follow the arrows rather than choosing the most convenient way". Another student also expressed similar opinions about hallway conditions. They expressed that "the condition of the school's hallways is doing better than it was pre-Covid but still, it is so jam-packed and is extremely difficult to social-distance. I think one-way hallways are easier to navigate around because there aren't people going both ways, making it easier to get to classes faster as well." The main concerns students are having are with regard to the lack of social distancing in these hallways. While it seems that most students agree on the fact that the crowded hallway conditions are less than desirable in these circumstances, many students have mixed opinions about the arrows in place to direct students through the one-way hallways. One student said that even though the arrows were there to help, they do not have a significant impact due to the large student population and the rush to get to class on time, which makes the hallways very busy and forces students to bump into each other. Another student stated that "I understand why the arrows are in place, but they're not at all convenient. You have to walk away from your class and go around the school before you can enter your classroom, which causes us to be late sometimes. I think some of the hallways should be changed up a bit." It is evident that with the students' growing concerns regarding the crowded conditions we see in our hallways, further consideration should be taken regarding this matter. Such solutions may include adjusting the directions of the one-way arrows, in order to distribute the large student population in certain stairwells at once, or even provide routes that don't force students to use congested hallways on their way to classes. It is crucial to consider what we can do to help students feel safe in our school.

PHOTOGRAPH BY VIVIEN JIN



CLOSURE By Stuart Chen

In all of our hearts, there is someone that we don't see anymore. Or maybe they were more than just someone, maybe multiple people, or maybe they've become a stranger, a vestige, a flickering ghost in your memories. Try as you might, their image always seems to fade from your squinted eyes; wisps of smoke curling away from their corporeal figure as you speak to extinguished ears about what the past should have been. They can't hear you anymore. It's a sad feeling, having words lingering on your consciousness that are still begging to be sent. If that's the case, though, why stay silent?

By some chance of life, you were able to meet them. By some grace of life, they still live on in your thoughts. After being passed through the grinding sands of time, each unsavory argument you felt was necessary, now seems like the last vibrations of a dying phone call, and their once-known id currently displays a new title: "unavailable". Try as you might, you can't contact them through conventional means anymore. Instead, find the strength to carry yourself forwards, towards a peace of your own making. Feet to the grass, pen to the paper, you are the only one who will ever forge the closure that you seek.

There's no shame in caring. These experiences are written into you, woven into your day-to-day life, and compounded in your subconscious, and if you were to not care, you'd examine the walls around your heart to find a stone missing. Why hide it? If phones and technology break down, carry your message to them on foot. If their smoky remnants are all you have left, hold their hand and show them the sky. You care, and that's enough of a reason. You care, and you'd be surprised: they just might too.

Like a billowing tree, whose branches reach out over the river
Petals drawing themselves out of their nests, to be carried away by the current
Searching not for the other side, but for something equally precious
A destination, not promised, not provided,
Where once again we may find our sanctuary.

I'M LOST

by Pal Prajapati

I'm walking. Step by step, each placed carefully as I try not to trip with my head bowed down as I focus on the mud-caked ground a few meters ahead of me. The controlled movements of my feet are calculated. I know where I want to go.

I don't know how long it's been. I've lost track of time, lost track of where I am, lost track of where I was going. I recall the cautious steps I had taken to make sure it wouldn't end up like this. Yet, when I looked up, I did not know where I was. Now, I stand here alone, as if walking through a graveyard, unable to keep track of the figures, hues of black, moving hastily around me. I'm being swept in the crowd and everything seems like a blur. I don't know where to go or which turn to take. The voices are muffled, and no one is responding to my frantic calls. I'm asking for directions, but everyone is too preoccupied with themselves. Unlike me, they seem to have a sense of direction, where they want to go and where they wish to be.

I wanted to turn back, but I was too busy looking at the ground. I'm not sure if I can retrace my steps. I was too focused on the path in front of me and had forgotten to stop and look around to see where I was. The balanced life I was aiming for wasn't reality. I had lost all control that I once had.

It's been a few days. Nothing I do is helping. I still can't find my way back, and no one can hear my cries. I want to find the key to the door that leads out of this prison, but it seems to have been thrown somewhere far away. The feeling I am most afraid of is starting to sink in more and more as each day passes by. What I attempted to control back then has now become a reality. This is not what I wanted.

I've finally realized. I'm lost.

I LOVE VIDEO GAMES!

by Rachell Trung

This simple fact about myself has been valid for most of my life. At first, I was only interested in video games because it was a mutual hobby that I could share with my older brothers. The moderately large age gap between us made spending time together challenging. Thus, video games helped ease these problems for us. For hours on end, I would watch my brothers with fascination. Usually, I would have the unplugged controller when we'd "play" together, but that never prevented me from enjoying the experience. I started appreciating video games on my own when I found a website that hosted a plethora of various flash games. There was one game which I particularly enjoyed called Castaway. I would play this strategy game for hours on end. In Castaway, you are a survivor stuck on a mysterious island. The purpose of the game is to explore and beat bosses along the way, and the riveting gameplay fascinated my young mind. A few years later, my brother bought and built his gaming PC. Through my brother's connections, I was revealed to the video game distributor known as Steam, which held countless video games that intrigued me. With the gaming PC, Steam, and my brother's wallet, I was exposed to higher-quality games that were captivating. The story and lore, the music, the graphics and visuals, the gameplay itself; I could see the dedication and effort put into each of these aspects, all of which created an enjoyable gaming experience. The world of video games began to wrap around me in an endless spiral. Not only was it an escape, but it was also a way for me to connect with my brother.

photograph by Kevin Hu

Pick-Me-Up Drinks

by Harini Gnanalingam

As the weather gets warmer, many people are starting to switch from warm lattes to iced drinks. You might be coming home from school feeling exhausted because of the heat and in need of energy to beat the scorching, hot temperatures. In preparation for the warmer weather, I have put together a few afternoon pick-me-ups that are not only thirst-quenching but also an excuse to treat yourself! Here are three recipes that I am obsessed with. You can change the recipes based on what ingredients you have at home!

✶Chocolate Milkshake

- 2 scoops of Vanilla ice cream
- 2 tablespoons of hot chocolate powder
- 1 teaspoon of cocoa powder
- ½ cup of milk of choice
- 3-4 ice cubes
- Optional: toppings of choice (whipping cream, chocolate shavings, more ice cream, etc.)

In a blender, pour in your vanilla ice cream, hot chocolate powder, cocoa powder, ice cubes, and milk of your choice.

Blend until there are no clumps of chocolate powder and the milkshake is at a smooth consistency.

Pour into a glass and add additional toppings of your choice.

Enjoy!

✶Earl Grey Iced Tea

- 1 bag of Earl Grey tea
- ½ cup of hot water
- 2 teaspoons of sweetener
- 1 tablespoon of lemon juice
- 3-5 iced cubes

Steep the teabag in hot water for 5 minutes.

After steeping the tea, remove the teabag from the hot water and mix in the lemon juice and sweetener.

Cool your iced tea for 15 minutes.

Fill another cup with ice and pour your tea mixture into the cup.

Stir and enjoy!

✶Iced Matcha Latte

- 2 teaspoons matcha powder
- ¼ cup of hot water
- ½ cup of milk of your choice
- sweetener to taste (I prefer agave!)
- 3-5 ice cubes

Sift matcha into a glass.

Pour ¼ cup of hot water into the glass with matcha powder.

Optional step: add your choice of sweetener.

Mix well with a utensil until there are no lumps of matcha left. (*Handy tip, use a milk frother to speed up the process!)

In a different glass, add your ice cubes and milk.

Top it off with your matcha concentrate.

Mix and enjoy!

✶

I hope these recipes help you stay refreshed and energized throughout the hot summer months! These recipes are adaptable with different ingredients so if you don't have something at home, feel free to substitute and try new combinations! Some suggestions are to substitute coffee for matcha (or mix them both together to make a dirty matcha iced latte), or instead of Earl Grey tea, use different types of black tea. Finally, another substitution you can make is to make a strawberry milkshake instead of a chocolate milkshake!

That Paper Towel Talk

By: Alison Hardy

4 years ago, I watched a TED talk titled “How to use a paper towel” by Joe Smith. As one would expect, the four-minute video simply covers the “proper” way to use paper towels. The reasoning behind the video is to minimize the tremendous amount of waste that paper towels create in the world, yet the concept of the video naturally comes across as bizarre at first. Throughout the talk, Joe Smith demonstrates that you only need to use one paper towel to dry your hands if you shake your hands and fold the paper towel beforehand. He also claims that if everyone cuts down their usage to one paper towel, a significant amount of waste can be prevented. Near the end of the talk, Joe Smith says, “Shake. Fold. You will for the rest of your life remember those words every time you pick up a paper towel” and so far, he has been right. Since watching that video, I have rarely used more than one paper towel to dry my hands. I am almost bothered when I see other people pull multiple towels that barely touch their hands before throwing them away, which may be the exact reason why that paper towel talk exists in the first place. Regardless of the peculiar nature of the presentation, it still managed to impact my behaviour and outlook. Moreover, if I imagine all the paper towels that I saved in the last four years, perhaps it is not that strange of a sentiment in the first place.

By: Allan Kong

The Last Step to Normal

By: Anika Gupta

It's been over a year since COVID-19 has been declared a pandemic and changed our lives for the worse. Most people just want the vaccine so life can go back to normal. However, many questions remain: When will we get our vaccines? Who will be eligible to receive it? What vaccines are available?

In Canada, four vaccines have been approved for use: Moderna, Pfizer, AstraZeneca, and Janssen (Johnson & Johnson), with more in line for approval. Every vaccine except the Janssen will require two doses for maximum protection. Vaccines will be given free of charge and I highly encourage you all to get it when it becomes available to you.

Speaking of availability, this is the breakdown of when you can expect to receive your vaccination. In Alberta, we have begun the rollout for phase 2.

Starting March 15 - Phase 2A

- Albertans born 1947 - 1956
- First Nations, Métis and Inuit persons born 1971 or earlier
- Staff and residents of senior home facilities who did not receive their vaccination in phase 1

April to June - Phase 2B

- Albertans born from 2005-1957 living with a high-risk underlying health condition

April to June - Phase 2C

- Residents and support staff at living and work settings where large outbreaks may occur
- All health care professionals and support staff
- Anyone working in patient care facilities or providing services to hospitals, labs, and clinical areas

April to June - Phase 2D

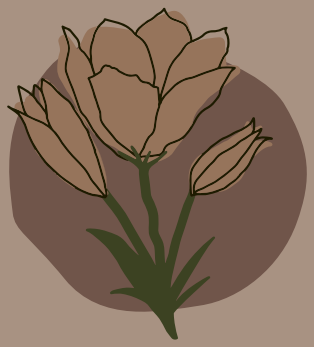
- Albertans born 1957 to 1971
- First Nations, Métis and Inuits who were born 1972-1986

Spring/Early Summer

- Any person from the general public

If all goes to plan it seems we will be able to enjoy our regular summer with the Stampede, beaches, and parks. Let's hope for the best!

sunday morning



BY DAPHNE DAWSON

It's Sunday morning and the fog has barely settled, late August when the morning air is crisp. The sky is purple and the sun is peeking over the horizon. You step outside with your mug in your hand and you take a breath.

You smell the morning dew on the plants in the garden and your vision is filled with the lush green of childhood. You're taken back to the times as a kid when you would spend all day in the mini forest behind the house. When you were an adventurer in your own backyard. The rainy part of spring when your socks were always wet. Where puddles were your destination and splashing was your mode of transport. You remember all the grass stains and rainstorms. The colours of the flowers you would pick when they were in bloom. A simpler time, when you still got along with your parents, before you moved away and lost contact with them. There are so many things you wish you could say.

The green fades to orange as the sun begins to rise. A breathtaking sight that reminds you of the mid-summer sun. Of paradise flavoured smoothies and crystal coloured pools. You're taken back to those moments of bliss when you would lay with your feet in the sand. The smell of sunscreen on your skin and the taste of sour candy on your lips. A place of mid-day naps and late evening fires, of steeping stones and sunburns. A simpler time, when you still got along with your friends, before you grew apart and lost contact with them. There are so many things you wish you could say.

You sip your drink and are filled with the warmth of your youth. You close your eyes and reminisce about the days when you could lay for hours watching movies. When weekends were filled with pillow forts and pancake breakfasts. You're blinded by the sparklers on birthday cakes and flashlights on camping trips. You remember every one of your stuffed animals' names. You're taken to a place where time doesn't move, where the cartoons never end. Where the evening turns to night and playdates turn to sleepovers. When you would stargaze after dark, then sleep till after lunch. A simpler time, when you still got along with yourself, before you grew up and lost contact with them. There are so many things you wish you could say.

the trial (pt. II)

BY GRIGORY SAMARSKIY

I begin walking towards the corner, where the sword sits calmly sheathed in its scabbard. No whispers, no calls for blood; just peace, uninhibited peace. Jade grabs me by the wrist before I can grip the scabbard.
I look up at her face, expecting rage, disappointment, or maybe even hatred. Instead, I see tears; sadness. Sheer sadness. "Please Jack... please... Don't do this. There is no good version of this. Either you die here today, or you kill my brother." I understand why she was silent now. She didn't want to show me this side of her, to see her desperate. She has always been open but this part, the part that just wants to beg, that doesn't have the strength to fight makes her ashamed of herself. I can sense it in her entire being. Little does she know all I see is power, strength, and a force of will that is absolute. "I can't lose either of you. Please, I just got him back, and..."
"No one is going to die today," I say, taking her into a hug. I had always wanted it to be true, but at this moment, this very infinitesimally small segment of time, I believe it. "I promise you. We will both live."
I hear a sigh emerge, one that knows such brazen stupidity all too well. "Well then Mr. Monrow, you'll need this." the professor states, tossing a small vial towards me.

I slip one hand out of the embrace, fumble for a second, then grasp the vial. A silver liquid sloshes around, almost like mercury. "That is a small gift, from me to you. Drink it all, and be sure to fight quickly. It's highly unstable, lasting for all of around a minute, give or take. It is also incredibly illegal in 11 of the 13 districts, including this one, which means that if anyone sees what it is, you will be parting with your life on completely different terms than what you would imagine."
"Thanks, Teach, I'll be careful."
"Oh, so now he listens to his elders," Bell smirks, loosening his necklace. "Well since its gift-giving time," he says, taking off the emerald pendant around his neck. As soon as it passes over his head, his form begins to shimmer. His tanned-white skin became replaced with a lavender colour. "It's more than just a glamour. After all, why would a crazy druid make a single-purpose object," he jokes, handing it to me.
At this point, Jade let me go, and Winn walks up to me. "And from me Sir Jackson Monrow, I grant you my most sacred of possessions." He dramatically lowers himself to one knee and presents his sword. "My holy blade."
"Are you sure my friend? This is a sacred symbol of your faith," I declare, trying my hardest not to crack a smile.
Winn gives off a hearty laugh, "Hell no! You get a pat on the back. Don't forget, I've been in this world for the same two months as you. If I find some magic artifacts or alchemical concoctions, I'm keeping 'em all to myself."
I let out a grin, "I would expect nothing less."

Spruce Up Your Closet, It's Spring!

Zara Abbas

The long-awaited moment is finally here. The weather is dabbling in double-digit temperatures, the sun is rising earlier and earlier each day, and still going strong by eight o'clock. It's finally spring.

For most, the warmth and promise of new beginnings are enough to get them through the long and dreary winters (in style, of course). The arrival of spring means that it's finally time to dig back into the depths of your closet and pull out your best sweaters and your favourite short sleeve shirts! Say goodbye to the chills that cover your body at the thought of bare arms.

However, spring fashion in Calgary is...unique. It remains relatively chilly here until at least late April. So, naturally, we need to be a little creative with how we'll bring forward our spring style without catching a cold!

Luckily for us, there is an abundance of clothes in this world that are perfect for this weather. Let's start with upper-body apparel. T-shirts may seem a little premature in this stage, so a little improvisation is necessary. Autumn and spring in Calgary are ideal sweater weather seasons. The magic is all in the colour scheme, and spring is all about those bright colours that signify new beginnings. Certain pairings such as long-sleeved shirts layered with short-sleeved t-shirts overtop are reclaiming their thrones in the fashion world, and are also a great way to stay cozy. Layering is definitely in style and keeping warm won't be an issue either. If that doesn't seem like your style, then let's think about early 2000s fashion; Y2K fashion is yet another powerful trend that is returning to popularity. Zip-ups and cropped tops to match your pants are a sure way to feel cozy yet still broaden your horizons. Don't be afraid to experiment with different styles! Spring is all about preluding and testing out what you want to pull off this summer.

Issues with choosing tops (such as poor weather) can always be amended quickly, however, bottoms require an entirely different structure of planning. For instance, choosing shorts to wear when it is 1℃ may not be the smartest choice. Keep your eye on the temperature and you may just be able to get away with wearing shorts or even skirts! Nothing screams springtime quite like letting your legs feel the cool air against them. If the weather is on the chilly side, then this is the time to wear whatever pants you feel the best in. Comfort is crucial. Whether you are most comfortable in mom jeans, skinny jeans, leggings, or sweatpants, you do you. Whatever you decide, wear it with confidence.

Lastly, accessories. Accessories can top off any outfit and elevate it from being basic to elegant. Springtime is the perfect time to wear colourful jewelry and take fashion risks. This expands beyond just jewelry, though. Take Harry Styles for example - at the Grammy awards, he rocked a purple boa! Remember, spring signifies new beginnings and nothing new comes without taking a leap of faith.

Spring weather is beautiful in the way that we slowly get to watch every flower bloom once more from its dead winter shells. It's time you brush off those dusty joints and spruce up your closet a little.

Photo by Allan Xing

Photo by Janelle Li

Mice and Dinosaurs

BY SAMUEL CHAN

I wanted to write about mice and dinosaurs,
But I didn't know where I would go with it.
Furry little rodents compared with enormous reptilians,
How would I go about connecting them?

In ancient times, there came animals that ruled the earth,
With fierce claws, raging speed, and terribly long necks.
But we didn't see them,
Not as we are now.
Instead we collect their history,
Preserve their bones.
It only leads me to wonder,
If someone, or something would come to collect ours.

On the other hand,
There is a dirty, little creature that we decided was a pest.
It scurries to build homes around our labours,
If it's not being used for experiments so that we could remain humanly ethical.
Would it's bones also be found,
To have a history created around their lives?
I wouldn't be able to say.

The things I wonder,
Would only be decided after we are all gone.
The things I wish to know,
Would not be answered to my heart's content.
I shouldn't stay up,
Knowing I wouldn't be satisfied.
I'll just keep thinking,
About the mice and the dinosaurs.

Cartoon

BY MATANGI PRIYA

Photograph

BY SOPHIA ZHANG

The Little Things

BY CANDY LANG

Kurt Vonnegut Jr. once said, "Enjoy the little things in life because one day, you'll look back and realize they were the big things." Said 'little things' are what hold people together, such as families, partners, and friendships. They are the actions that we, as humans, do for each other, whether it be for our loved ones, bosses, teachers, friends, acquaintances, classmates, or even complete strangers. These actions may seem small by scale, at least in the moment. However, their value is greater than what meets the eye. The little things are memories, or parts of larger memories that will hopefully last forever and be reminisced at one point in another's life. So, let's try not to overlook the small details because those details are what form whatever grand or life-changing moment you see before you.

WHY QUINN FABRAY DESERVED BETTER

BY: DAISY LIU

Glee isn't a show I would sincerely recommend to anyone. I have many criticisms, but one of my biggest pet peeves has always been how the producers handled Quinn Fabray's character. For those who have not seen Glee, Quinn is a popular head cheerleader. She's also a bully, which is her defining character trait. However, as the show progresses, the audience slowly comes to realize that even though Quinn displays classic mannerisms that paint her as the villain of the story, we don't truly see her as one. It almost feels like a form of deceptive malevolence.

The plot of Glee may be questionable, but the characters have always stayed consistent; the same can not be said for Quinn, which is partly what makes her interesting. The audience sees this distinct tug-of-war within her: a part of her wishes that she could meet the expectations that her family name inherently carries, while the other is tired of the self-imposed isolation that comes with popularity. As a result, Quinn experiences a distinct loss of identity because of the innate power-struggle between the two. She doesn't understand how to find balance or a common middle-ground that will accommodate her needs, so instead, she adopts the extremes of both sides. This makes it so that sometimes she's merciless and other times she's benevolent. This split in personalities is amplified by the actress that portrays her: Dianna Agron. As the show continues, Dianna manages to bring this sense of humility to Quinn, which Ryan Murphy (the producer of Glee) has once outright stated he was against. He didn't want Quinn to learn how to overcome her prejudices. His goal was to make Quinn out to be the villain of most stereotypical American high schools. When the audience began to sympathize with some of Quinn's redeeming qualities, rumour has it that Murphy began having conflicts with Dianna Agron.

They practically destroyed her character. I'm not going to name every little thing that happened, but I will talk about her ending. Quinn ended up in a picket-white-fence type of marriage. Now, there's nothing inherently wrong with that. However, this is infuriating because it was terribly out of character for her. By the time the show was nearing its end, Quinn was a decently good human being. However, to be a good person, Quinn had to give up her family so that she could re-learn compassion and empathy. These were traits that her parents had labelled to be synonymous with weak. She was ambitious and desperate to leave her hometown so that she could pursue her dreams and passions. She even talks about how she doesn't want to be tied down by her relationships. That is why there is no conceivable way Quinn Fabray would ever settle for a perfectly standard marriage that shackled her to the city. That was something her parents have always wanted for her, not something she would ever willingly pick herself. It nullified every development that she had gone through by basically stating that she ended up exactly where she thought she would be at the beginning of the show. Six seasons later and Quinn had lost all her development! She definitely deserved better.

WHAT IS MALADAPTIVE DAYDREAMING?

Practically everybody daydreams. You could be sitting in math class, with your teacher droning on and on about graphing polynomial functions and solving trigonometric equations. Out of boredom and fatigue, you imagine yourself sitting on a sunny beach in Hawaii, or skiing in the Swiss Alps, or practically anywhere except for that math class. It's completely normal; daydreaming is a way for people to escape an undesirable or dissatisfying reality. There is, however, such a thing as daydreaming too much. One might constantly imagine themselves living a completely different life, with different friends, different family members, and a different occupation. They might be so unhappy or miserable with the life they are living that they create a new, ideal life for themselves. That is what is known as maladaptive daydreaming.

Maladaptive daydreaming is a disorder that is often a symptom of OCD, depression, anxiety, or ADHD. Imaginings that are caused by it typically include detailed settings, characters, and plots that are extremely vivid. Often, these daydreams play out in a person's mind as if they are stories. Someone with the disorder might have daydreams that are triggered by a variety of real-life events, including day-to-day conversations and even noises or smells. A person with maladaptive daydreaming can often have difficulties sleeping or completing regular tasks, and might even begin to dissociate themselves from friends and family members. The discord between the individual's ideal life and their reality may cause them to choose to retreat into their imagination, which they might find more interesting or appealing. Overall, while daydreaming might be a comforting way to liberate oneself from a loathsome or displeasing situation, it can sometimes become extremely detrimental to many different facets of their life.

Because this disorder has only been identified very recently, not many studies have been done on it yet. Therefore, not much is truly known about how to treat it or how it is caused. There are also no certain ways to diagnose it. However, despite this lack of knowledge about maladaptive daydreaming, researchers believe that it is typically a result of immense abuse or psychological trauma, which is similar to what can cause depression or OCD. There is also evidence that suggests that triggers that cause an individual to daydream may be mitigated by going to therapy and talking with a professional psychiatrist. This can often help them determine and avoid their triggers, as well as potentially ascertain some of the causes of the disorder.

PHOTOGRAPH BY: ERIC ZHAO

SPRING

By Maida

Look at the trees swinging in the wind,
Flowers blooming fresh and calm.
Look around, nature's giving you a hint
Isn't it a great surprise of charm?

Dark sun, short days are gone
Coldness, harshness of winter has faded away,
A hope has risen from the sun of dawn
So now begin again with this day.

Think of these blessings you have around,
So cherish the beauty and look at everything you have found
Happiness is now your duty.

Let the smile on your face remain
There is so much to gain.

Happy first of spring everyone!

No more dark days, no more snow, and no more cold. The flowers are blooming and mother nature is calling for a fresh and bright season again. I'm looking forward to the feeling of the sunbeams warming our skin and the refreshing sips of cold beverages. What's more, the beauty of nature is to finally be seen again after such a harsh winter. There will once again be the sounds of birds chirping in the early mornings, the ability to finally be outdoors, and even being able to plant our own gardens.

Your duty for the weekend is to discover something new, do something creative, spend your time wisely and find value in doing the things that make you happy. As well, fill yourself up with positivity and take out all of the stress that has been built up inside of you during school. My hopes are for all of you to have an amazing spring and to be looking forward to the new season as much as I am.

DESPAIR

By Umar Mohammed Yousuf

Cookie stained ballads,
Stoned with white words.
Raucous deviants fining lines,
That fine lies.
Delicate stabs,
smeared with juxtaposing fingers.
Disdainful howls of,
Perfection realized.

by Umair Mir

Team Management Gone Wrong: The Buffalo Sabres' Head Coach Story

Arnav Patil

The Buffalo Sabres (a professional hockey team) have fired head coach Ralph Krueger, becoming the third team to do so this year (after Montreal and Calgary). One cannot help but remember the Great Coach Purge of 2019-2020: a time when player-abuse scandals and poor goaltender performances led to 15 out of the 31 teams hiring new coaching staff.

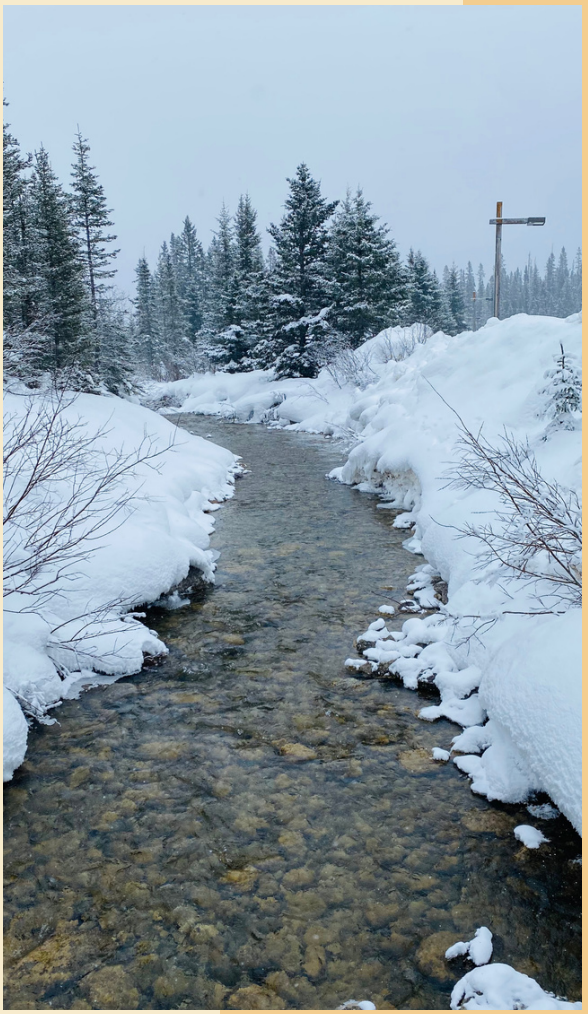
The Buffalo Sabres are on a twelve-game losing streak, ranking lowest in the league for points. They have six wins, which is the same amount as they have lost without scoring a single goal.

Ralph Krueger has a reputation for being a very motivated coach; he has led the Swiss national team in the past and assisted Mike Babcock for Team Canada at the 2014 Sochi Games, where Canada won Olympic Gold. He also spent some years coaching a soccer team in the English Premier League, and joined the NHL as the Edmonton Oilers' head coach in 2012. It is worth noting that he has never completed a full 82-game NHL season, which experts say might have an impact on his performance this year as a coach.

As for the team itself, the captain of the Buffalo Sabres, Jack Eichel, is injured indefinitely with an upper-body injury. Taylor Hall and Eric Staal, two of the other prominent players on the Sabres, have also had a lacklustre season scoring only 16 and 10 points respectively. But there is a chance that the Sabres' rough times could be attributed to their management rather than the players themselves. On average, the Buffalo Sabres have had to put up with tactics changes and perspective shifts more than other teams. As stated, Krueger has never finished an 82-game season; in fact, he is the Sabres' fifth coach since 2013. There is also controversy around his coaching abilities that came to light after he benched a vital player for three games. First-time general manager (GM) Kevyn Adams, the person who finalized the decision to fire Krueger, is the team's third manager in six years. This also hints at potential GM incompetency, which can set a team back for seasons after the GMs depart.

On top of the 2020 league bubbles in Edmonton and Toronto (all teams play in the same two cities) and this year's new format, the players on the Sabres have had to adapt. New styles, new paradigms and an increasingly competitive sport can all have an impact on the mental health and physical performance of the players. If the Sabres do nothing now, they risk missing the playoffs for the tenth year in a row, a drought that would tie the current NHL record. This is why one could view firing Ralph Krueger to be the wrong decision or one that was made prematurely. As the stronger senior players on the team are injured/in a slump, the storm that management creates could have a dramatic effect on some youngsters' careers. It will be interesting to see what direction the team chooses to go from here, but for now, Sabres fans can mark the potential beginning of a new chapter in Sabres hockey.

by Noor Khan



MARVEL QUESTIONS AND THEORIES ARE FINALLY GETTING ANSWERED

Starring Kelly He

After Endgame was released in April 2019, it felt like a bittersweet era coming to a close with Captain America's unexpected aging and Tony Stark's heroic death. But let's be honest, we all had a lot of questions that were left hanging. Where did Loki portal to when he was accidentally handed the Tesseract? Who's going to save the universe now that the leaders of our entire team are either deceased or struggling with arthritis. And the repetitive one, when the heck is Black Widow finally going to be released?

For those who are not quite caught up with the scheduling of releases this year, here is a very quick summary:

Black Widow - May 7th **Loki** - June 11th **Shang Chi and the Legends of the Ten Rings** - July 9th
Eternals - November 5th **Spider-man: No Way Home** - December 17th

When asked about the upcoming Marvel releases, a grade 10 student expresses excitement towards the long-awaited Black Widow film. "I'm so stoked to watch Black Widow. It has been taking forever and I really would love to see her character and story in a more in-depth perspective." Along with another student's comment: "I'm excited for basically all the new stuff and I'm also pumped for Black Widow because it's already been delayed three times and I need to watch it so bad because she's one of my favourite characters. I love that another female superhero is getting her own movie. Also, I loved WandaVision and I'm sad that it was such a short season."

While a lot of us are still as excited as ever for Scarlett Johansson's own movie, the long wait has left some people feeling like it's been drawn out too much and lacks its original anticipation. Throughout the Avengers movies and especially in Age of Ultron, we are hinted at Natasha Romanoff's past through flashbacks and conversations but are never told the full parts of her story. She became a founder of the Avengers after having a difficult past as a young assassin and worked alongside superheroes. She was never considered a weak link. In fact, she was one of the strongest, both mentally and physically. Due to her character development and strength, her death in Endgame was one of the most tragic and heartbreaking, but also represented how much she's grown as a person, willing to sacrifice herself to save Clint.

A number of grade ten students were asked which upcoming Marvel film or show they're most excited for in an Instagram survey and the obvious favourite was Spider-Man 3, with Black Widow as a runner-up. We've all heard many theories surrounding the third Spider-Man movie, knowing that Doctor Strange is going to play an important role along with the slight possibility of Andrew Garfield and Toby Maguire being in the film. Some comic fans wonder if the movies will take on the story of Peter Parker's troubles after his identity is revealed. But all we can do is wait! One grade 10 student expresses his concern about the interference of Sony in the process and hopes the film will still be amazing. Fans — especially Asians — are ecstatic to see Simu Liu as Shang-Chi in the upcoming Marvel film. With this being Marvel's first-ever Asian lead, it's been a long-anticipated moment of representation and impact for the Asian community. Be sure to mark those release dates on your calendar!

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR THE MONTH

Brought to you by Yasmeen Naseem!

1. **Avengers: Infinity War** - Produced by Joe and Anthony Russo
Everyone's favourite superheroes unite in one movie to stop the warlord, Thanos, from collecting all the infinity stones and destroying reality as is known. Ensure you have a decent amount of popcorn and tissues while watching this cinematic masterpiece.

2. **The Princess and the Frog** - Directed by John Musker and Ron Clements
A classic Disney movie based around Tiana, a young waitress in New Orleans, working to fulfill her father's dying wish. However, she must first embark on a journey with an undercover prince to discover who she really is along with her place in the world.

3. **Creed** - Directed by Ryan Coogler
The son of a renowned boxing champion, Adonis Creed must accept his destiny as a boxer while learning of his father's past along the way.

4. **Attack on Titan** - Directed by Masashi Koizuka
A popular Japanese animated series tells the story of a world in which man-eating titans appeared 100 years prior. Despite being safe behind man-made walls for quite a while, humanity is once again threatened when the walls start to collapse. Soldier Eren Jaeger and his comrades must work together to ensure the survival of humanity once and for all.

"How Could They Think Like That?" The Disconnect Between Parents and Kids

-Anonymous

It's strange that so many of us turned out so different from the people who raised us. It's unfathomable how our views, values, and beliefs can contradict the views of our parents, the people who we see everyday. It seems that now more than ever, kids and parents disagree on everything. Not just the small issues, like curfews and rules, but worldwide issues, like human rights, politics, and economy.

"How could they be so stupid!" an exasperated grade 10 student told the Chronicle about her parents and their opinion on a protest going on in their home country. "How can anybody even think like that?" All of the students interviewed found their parents considerably more conservative, or right winged, than them. "Sometimes, I wonder how my parents would have turned out if they had grown up in present times," remarked a grade 11 student.

So how come our parents think so differently? There are some possible explanations. In Churchill, a school known for its diversity, many of our parents came from different countries. They grew up in a completely different environment, with different expectations, opinions, and events. In Northwest Calgary, we don't experience the same things as our parents did. Not to mention, our parents grew up in a different time period than us. In today's day and age, we are exposed to more information than our parents through the media. Our views are influenced by more than just those around us. But, no matter what time period we are in, teenagers and parents have disagreed.

Students interviewed say they have been feeling very disconnected from their parents. It can be difficult to respect, or get along with people who disagree with you on topics you feel are important. "I can't talk to them about anything anymore," expressed a grade 10 student. "It always ends in an argument." Some students feel as though their parents don't understand things that are important to them. It also feels as though their parents aren't listening to them. "It's like they don't take me seriously," complained a grade 11 student. "I'm not old enough to have an opinion on politics, I guess." Students I've spoken to say their parents disregard their opinions, and assume that students don't understand what is going on, especially because they disagree.

We've grown up in such a different way than our parents have. It seems obvious that we are not going to agree with them on everything. If you ever feel disconnected from your parents, just remember you're not in this alone. Churchill is here to support you, along with your peers. Don't let go of your opinions just because your parents think you're not smart enough to have them. Who your parents are shouldn't define you.

'-R-': A Breakdown

-Manvir D

At 10 p.m. MST on Thursday, March 11, Blackpink member Rosé released her long-awaited mini-album '-R-'. The album contains the tracks "On The Ground" and "Gone".

Rosé held two live streams leading up to the release of -R-: one on V-Live (a streaming app), and the other on Youtube right before the release. The V-Live stream was the main event and featured food, games, and spoilers. The YouTube release was hosted by Little Bacon Bear. Here, we saw her act out what her music makes her feel. She also played songs on different instruments and called her sister to join in on the interview.

The exterior of the physical album is a collage of Rosé consisting of several pictures from this era (an era is a period during which an album is being promoted). The album comes with a photobook, lyric sheet, four postcards, two polaroids, a sticker set, a double-sided poster, and of course a CD for her two songs.

The title track "On the Ground" consists of two main tones: an energetic, electric pop chorus, and calm sorrow verses in between. This creates a stark but welcome contrast. The music video features multiple stunning outfits from Rosé, including a giant floppy hat and a black and pink dress. It also contained many impactful scenes, such as Rosé flying over a field of roses and a meteor impact that explodes a limo. One of the most memorable scenes that showcased this music video's extreme budget was Rosé running through a sign that spewed fireworks. The music video also broke the record for the K-Pop solo video with the most views in 24 hours. With 41.6 million views, it broke PSY's previous record of 36 million for one of K-Pop's biggest hits, "Gangnam Style".

The second track "Gone" was much slower and more melancholy compared to its counterpart "On the Ground". "Gone" was first debuted at "The Show" (Blackpink's first virtual concert held at the end of January). This solo was a huge success for Rosé and YG. I'm sure every Blink is excited for their next project, which will most likely be Lisa's solo coming later this year.

Aardvark Rights By Ameen Naqvi

A recent survey has shown an overwhelming support for the aardvark, as over 82.7% of the group surveyed believed that the animal should be able to receive a driver's license at will. The group that supported these mammals went through extraordinary lengths to support their cause, even going as far as storming into a leader's room and overthrowing said leader due to their inaction on certain issues. The main opposing argument on this issue comes from the view that only humans should be given the privilege of driving, but in reality, other animals have been given transport related jobs in the past. Horses and camels have been used to transport people and goods for a much longer time period, and an ape was given the job of train station operator at a point in time as well. If these animals are able to carry out transportation duties, one of the advocates asked: "why are none allowed to drive a car? The simplest and most widespread vehicle is off-limits to the animal kingdom." Some point towards the aardvark's lack of interest in driving, but this is argued to be solely because they do not have any such rights.

Due to the aardvark's inability to take a driver's license test, it has been suggested that the animal should receive the license for free if it requests it. The activists believe "this would definitely change the roads and give lawmakers reason to update traffic laws". Debate still continues and lawmakers fear what side effects may come with this change, as well as what steps will be undertaken in support of this cause.

*Disclaimer: The events in this article did happen and nothing false is being stated, but it is being worded in a unique way.

Teacups of Love By Nousha Reaz

With a heavy steel canister in one hand, paper cups in the pocket of his brown apron, running like lightning, Kirtan, the *chaiwala* entered coach number three of the express train which had arrived in the wee hours of the morning. "Chai! Masala chai! Fresh tea!" rang out Kirtan's loud voice as he moved along the wooden seats in the compartment pouring cups of tea. Most of the passengers were still sleeping. The train had just left the station and the next station was an hour away. Kirtan had to empty the tea canister before he reached the next station where he would disembark and take the next train going back to his original destination. He had at least a dozen trips left to sell tea.

Kirtan grew up watching his entire family working in the railway station as vendors selling lunch packets, fruits, and tea for the train passengers. The only job he knew was to sell tea and hand over the money to his mother at the end of the day. He hadn't seen much of the world, much less outside his city. All these years, Kirtan never had any curiosity or inclination to go beyond the second station. During vacations and weekends, business was brisk. His canister would be drained within just two compartments. Many times, he observed how his tea worked like a bridge of friendship, even love, among total strangers. He vividly remembers a young man buying a cup of chai for the young woman sitting opposite him, and before he knew it, they were chatting away like old friends. Satisfied, Kirtan the 'Chai Cupid', (the role he had appointed to himself), had moved on to the next compartment.

It was a Sunday. The famous 'Kanti Express train' entered the station. Most of the passengers were still in deep sleep - only a few elderly passengers were up as a matter of habit. There was a great relief to see the *chaiwala*. Kirtan sold almost a dozen cups of hot tea without barely lifting a finger. He softly uttered " Chai, *garam* (hot) chai," so as to not disturb the sleeping passengers. He had almost reached the end of the compartment when he suddenly heard a soft voice calling him. He turned back to see one beautiful slim hand with painted fingernails summoning him. Kirtan was suddenly drawn to this elegant hand and at the same time was curious to see the face, but the face was hidden under a veil. He slowly moved to the berth and took a paper cup and poured the sweet hot liquid and offered it to the girl.

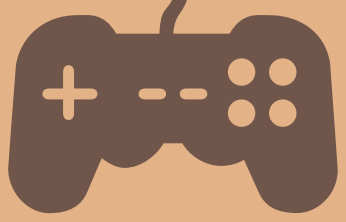
"How much does this cup cost?" asked the mysterious stranger in a sweet voice. Ironically, Kirtan the 'Chai Cupid' was now himself struck by cupid's arrow. He found himself unable to speak a word. The girl frantically searched for her wallet only to realize that her wallet was gone. Huge tears started falling from her face like pearls broken from a string. Kirtan understood and told her not to bother paying him. The girl explained that her concern was not paying for the tea but how she would get home with no money. He quickly took out a crumpled hundred rupee note and gave it to her. She shook her head but he insisted. "I sell tea in every train that passes this station. If God willing we meet again, you can pay me back," said Kirtan with an indescribable feeling in his chest.

Kirtan realized that for the first time he had missed his usual station and had to travel back two stations to reach home. But for once, he didn't care.

Game of the Month

Game of the Month: [Terraria By: Re-Logic]

By: **Jackson Qi**



What is Terraria?

Terraria is a 2D sandbox game developed by Re-Logic, in collaboration with Pipeworks Studios, 505 Games S.r.l, Codeglue, and Engine Software, released on May 16, 2011. It is an action game following a plot line similar to most other RPG games of obtaining weapons, beating bosses, and getting stronger items and repeating the process until the endgame is reached. Terraria's first update was released on May 17, 2011, a day after its official release. The beginning of Terraria saw no bosses, no events, and no hardmode. However, the amount of updates came gradually, eventually adding its first boss on June 10, hardmode on December 1, and its first event on December 15 on its first Christmas update. The last and final update came out in May of last year. The game now has over a dozen bosses and over 500 weapons with 19 different events. Terraria has made it onto this game of the month due to the powerful and impactful journey of the game, from starting out small to becoming one of the best selling games on Steam.

The History of Terraria

Terraria has come a long way as a 2D sandbox game with four major updates that brought the game to life. Its first major update was 1.1, which added hardmode, a new upgrade from easy mode in which you had to beat the "wall of flesh", the final easy mode boss to transition into hard mode (this was an irreversible process). Along with hard mode, the three mechanical bosses were added along with wings, new mechanisms and item modifiers. The second major update was update 1.2, which was by far the biggest update in Terraria's history. This added more new events, one new biome called "the Crimson", four new bosses, a new ore being Chlorophyte and a variety of new craftable and droppable weapons. This update was celebrated as the major transition for Terraria. The next update was the 1.3 update, the second largest update in Terraria's history. This update added a final boss, "the moonlord", and a variety of overpowered weapons to go with it. It also added the lunar events, the major end game event as well as the "Martian Madness" event, bringing forward new mid-game items as well as a new boss. The last update, known as 1.4 or simply Journey's End added two new bosses, a brand new gamemode and new mini biomes. This update, however, is smaller than both the 1.3 and the 1.2 update, yet it ends Terraria's journey on a great note as it was the most hyped update yet. So far, there have been no plans to add a 1.5 update in the near future, which marks the end of Terraria.

Anti-Asian Racism In North America

Mehak Dhatt

This past year, we have witnessed a troubling rise in Anti-Asian racism in all of North America, including the City of Calgary. The Calgary Police Service have said that they have seen an obvious and large rise in racially motivated hate crimes towards the Asian community within the last year, but do not have a breakdown of the numbers. This has become a large issue all over Canada, with a rise in hate crimes being seen in cities like Toronto and Vancouver as well; Vancouver has seen a rise of more than 700% between 2019 and 2020. In Calgary, it has become a weekly occurrence to witness or hear about instances of racism towards the Asian community: people being spat at, yelled at, and physically assaulted. Fear has been a predominant emotion that people of the community are feeling, and these actions of racism are much bolder and more outright.

I had a conversation with a student at our school that would like to remain anonymous, and they had a very clear feeling of fear not only for themselves, but also for their family. An emotion that I saw even more clearly than the fear was the anger they held. To quote the student they feel "angry about the fact that [they] have to go to sleep wondering if [their] grandparents and parents are safe from these racist actions." They were upset by the pattern of racism being most commonly targeted towards the people that they respect most in their culture: their elders. This student said that their "family has been nothing but kind, compassionate, and patient with this country," yet they are being treated like a threat, like outsiders.

I asked this student how their day-today life has been impacted by these events. Their response was something that no one should have to deal with: "I have to warn my grandparents to take one of their children with them when going on morning walks, as well as warning my mom not to go anywhere without us or friends." They also told me that they have found the need to be more aware of their own surroundings when out in public. There is this constant cloud of fear looming over them and their family, along with every one of the Asian community.

In a survey done in June 2020 by the Angus Reid Institute, out of 500 Canadians of Chinese ethnicity, half, 250, had been called names or insulted due to Covid -19, and a large number of people also reported being threatened due to the pandemic.

This is unacceptable. No one should have to live in a constant state of fear. We must work together as a city to combat this rise in racism.

The Reality of Dreams

By Raheena Lalani

Dreams can represent many things. Therefore, there is no right or wrong interpretation of what they mean. Some scientists believe that dreams represent the innermost desires and thoughts of individuals, while others say they help solve problems people face in their daily lives.

A study from 2013 published in a journal titled “Brain” described normal dreams as emotional and bizarre, with many complex elements. The findings from the study suggested that dreams originate from mental processes in the brain during the REM (Rapid Eye-Movement) stage of sleep. They also result from parts of the brain that handle higher-level thinking, which could potentially explain the absurdity of dreams.

When we dream, it is similar to when we become so engrossed in a task we lose ourselves to the experience. During a state of unconsciousness, our mind tends to wander and become detached from our daily lives. We then enter a world that we create for ourselves through dreaming.

When studying the different stages of sleep, dreams within the REM stage are distinct in comparison to those of the other stages. This is the stage in which dreams become more intense and represent occurrences in reality. It is here that we are entering into this new dimensional world. The parts of the brain that play a role in this phase are the hippocampus and the amygdala which are related to memory and emotional reactions. This can explain why dreams in this stage contain both motor and sensory components of our subconscious feelings and emotions. Therefore, the REM stage of sleep is a critical part of dreaming as it is where dreams become deeper.

Although the REM stage of sleep is mentioned quite frequently in relation to dreams, there are also four other stages of sleep. These are grouped into the S phase and the D phase, which make up the first two and the last two stages respectively. These compose the majority of sleeping time throughout the night. The S phase is known to be your brain recuperating from a long day, and the D phase is where dreams are initiated. These dreams are shorter in comparison to dreams occurring in the REM stage of sleep.

The Rise in Hate Crimes Against Asians

By Rutuja Singh

On March 16th, 2021, a mass shooting in Atlanta, USA killed 8 people including 6 women of Asian descent. The suspect of this shooting is 21-year old Robert Aaron Long. The shooting took place across three spa and massage stores. The first shooting happened at Young Asian’s Massage Parlor, killing and injuring 5 people in the store. The second shooting took place in Gold Massage Spa, 27km away from Young Asian’s Parlor, killing 3 women. The last shooting took place in Aromatherapy Spa, which is across the street from Gold Massage Spa, where another woman was found dead. Cherokee County Chief Jay Baker stated to the reporters, “He was pretty much fed up and kind of at the end of his rope, and yesterday was a really bad day for him, and this is what he did”. The statement by the chief outraged individuals, because it felt as though this horrendous crime was being dismissed and justified based on the shooter’s “bad day”. Long’s statement on his motive was that he had a sexual addiction and it was “temptation for him that he wanted to eliminate”. Asian women have been fetishized in mainstream media and have made them susceptible to sexual and physical violence.

Since March 2020, due to Covid-19 hate crimes against Asians in Canada have risen more than in the States. Vancouver reported that there was a 717% increase in anti-Asian hate crimes, and Toronto has the second-highest number of cases.

To raise awareness on social media people have used hashtags such as #stopaapihate, and #stopasianhate. One of the victim’s sons, Randy Park, had started a GoFundMe campaign which has reached more than $1.5 million in a day in order to financially support his family. President Biden and Vice President Harris denounced the attacks on Asian Americans and have set up a meeting with the Asian leaders in Atlanta. Many celebrities of Asian descent have spoken up about the issue including Eric Nam, CL, Jay Park, and Michelle Zauner. To make a difference within our community you can do your part by raising awareness on social media, signing petitions, donating money to organizations and the families of the victims.